C4.2 About snoop filtering

Snoop filtering tracks the cache lines that are allocated in a master's cache. To support an external snoop filter, a cached master must be able to broadcast which cache lines are allocated and which are evicted.

Support for an external snoop filter is optional within the ACE protocol. A master component must state in its data sheet if it provides support. See Chapter C10 *Optional External Snoop Filtering* for the mechanism the ACE protocol supports for the construction of an external snoop filter.

For a master component that does not support an external snoop filter, the cache line states permitted after a transaction has completed are less strict.

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